

How to Play Da A (Da Da A)

An Inner Mongolian Card Game

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What is Da A?

- A popular card game from Inner Mongolia, China.
- Typically played with 5 players using multiple decks of cards.
- A partnership game where alliances are formed based on holding the "Big A".
- The goal is for your team to shed all of your cards first.

The "Big A"

- At any point during the deal, a player with an Ace can reveal it to establish that suit as the "Big A" suit.
- **Countering ("Fan A"):** Another player can overturn this by showing two Aces of a different suit. This new suit becomes the "Big A" suit.
- **Reclaiming:** The original player can reclaim the "Big A" status if they also hold two Aces of their declared suit.
- Once the "Big A" suit is finalized, teams are set.

Teams and Starting Play

- **Teams:** The players holding the "Big A" cards of the designated suit form one team. All other players are on the opposing team. The player with the "other" Big A is called the "Ci Fang."
- **Starting the Game:** The "Ci Fang" can choose to lead the first trick by showing their other "Big A."
- If they don't, the original player who established the "Big A" suit leads.
- Play proceeds counter-clockwise.

Winning and Losing

- **Big A Team Wins:** If a player from the "Big A" team gets rid of their cards first, AND the last player with cards is on the opposing team.
- **Big A Team Loses:** If a non-"Big A" player gets out first, OR the last player with cards is on the "Big A" team.
- All other outcomes are a draw.
- **Special Rule:** A player holding two "Big A"s *must* be the first to get rid of all their cards, otherwise they automatically lose.

Card Ranking (High to Low)

- 1 Big A (The Ace of the established suit)
- 2 Red Joker
- 3 Black Joker
- 4 3
- 5 2
- 6 Regular A (any non-Big A)
- 7 K, Q, J, 10, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4

Singles (Dan Pai)

- **Description:** Any single card.
- **Ranking:** Follows the standard card ranking.
- **Example:** A single Q♥ can be beaten by a single K♠, 2♣, or higher.

Pairs (Dui Zi)

- **Description:** Two cards of the same rank.
- **Ranking:** A pair of 5s is beaten by a pair of 6s.
- **Example:** 7♥ 7♠ is a Pair. It can be beaten by J♣ J♦.

Sequence (Dan Long)

- **Description:** Three or more cards of sequential rank. Note: 2s and 3s can connect to 4s in a sequence.
- **How to beat it:**
 - A higher-ranking sequence of the same length.
 - Any Bomb (three or more of a kind).
- **Example:** 5♥ 6♠ 7♣ 8♦ can be beaten by 6♦ 7♥ 8♠ 9♣ or by three Jacks.

Paired Sequence (Shuang Long)

- **Description:** Three or more consecutive pairs. Note: 2s and 3s can connect to 4s.
- **How to beat it:**
 - A higher-ranking paired sequence of the same length.
 - A Bomb of **four or more cards**. (A three-card bomb is not enough!)
- **Example:** 8♥ 8♠ 9♣ 9♦ 10♥ 10♠ can be beaten by four Jacks.

Double Jokers (Shuang Wang)

- **Description:** A pair of Jokers (one Red, one Black).
- **Power:** Beats all standard hands and regular Bombs (Zha Dan).

Sequential Trios (Lian Zhu Dan)

- **Description:** Exactly three consecutive trios/bombs. Note: 2s and 3s can connect to 4s.
- **Power:** Beats Double Jokers.
- **Example:** 5♥5♠5♣ 6♥6♠6♣ 7♥7♠7♣

Fake Eight (Jia Ba)

- **Description:** Two consecutive four-of-a-kinds (Bombs).
- **Power:** Beats Sequential Trios.
- **Example:** Four 9s and four 10s played together.

Real Seven (Zhen Qi)

- **Description:** Seven or eight cards of the same rank.
- **Power:** Beats a Fake Eight. An extremely rare and powerful hand.

The Power of the 4

The 4 is the lowest ranking card, but has a unique ability:

- A single 4 is just a low card.
- A pair of 4s can be played to capture a three-card Bomb played by an opponent.
- Three 4s can capture a four-card Bomb.
- Four 4s can capture a five-card Bomb, and so on.

When you play the 4s, you immediately take the captured cards into your hand. Play then continues with the 4s being the played hand.

Pushing the Wind (Tui Feng)

This rule applies when a player goes out and no one can beat their final hand.

- If the other "Big A" teammate is known (has been revealed), the player "pushes" their last hand to their partner.
- If the teams are not yet fully clear, the hand is "pushed" to the next player in turn.

Hierarchy of Hand Types

A higher-ranked hand type can beat any hand type below it.

- 1 **Double Big A (Shuang Da A)** - Unbeatable
- 2 **Four Jokers (Si Wang)**
- 3 **Three Jokers (San Wang)**
- 4 **Real Seven (Zhen Qi)** - 7-8 of a kind
- 5 **Fake Eight (Jia Ba)** - Two consecutive 4-of-a-kinds
- 6 **Sequential Trios (Lian Zhu Dan)** - Exactly 3 consecutive trios
- 7 **Double Jokers (Shuang Wang)**
- 8 **Bomb (Zha Dan)** - 3+ of a kind
- 9 **Standard Hands:** Paired Sequence, Sequence, Pair, Single.

Note: Standard Hands are generally beaten by a higher-ranked hand of the same type or by a Bomb (see specific slides for exceptions).

Thank You! Any Questions?

The best way to learn it is to play now!